

Blue Eye USB 2.0 portable hard drive

All that you can't leave behind

The Blue Eye portable hard drive is a USB 2.0 compliant drive that fits into your shirt pocket. It draws power from the USB interface and is virtually silent while operating. The drive specifications clearly state that it is a USB 2.0 compliant device; yet it failed to operate on a variety of motherboards supporting this standard.

The drive was consistently detected as a generic USB 1.1 drive and the scores for data transfers were quite abysmal. When a single 711 MB data file was transferred, it took about 11 minutes 57 seconds, equating to a data transfer rate just under an MB per second. The drive is available in 5, 10, 20, 30 and 40 GB capacities.



ities. Since the drive is available in larger capacities, the USB 2.0 functionality becomes all the more critical when working with large files. You may want to wait for newer drivers that enable the USB 2.0 compliance before purchasing the drive.

Apart from this limitation, it is a good portable solution and will lend itself well to users who have to transfer files from place to place on a daily basis in a rugged and compact form factor.

SPECIFICATIONS

USB 2.0 compliant, available in 5, 10, 20, 30 and 40 GB capacities

Price: Rs 16,500 (for 30 GB)
Contact: Wales Technologies
Phone: 022-382 8100
E-mail: sales@walestechnologies.com
Web site: www.ibm.com

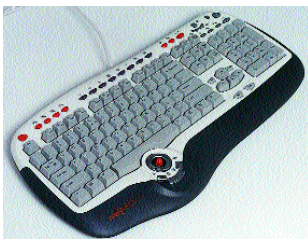
Blue Eye USB 2.0

Performance	▶▶▶▶▶
Build quality	▶▶▶▶▶
Value for money	▶▶▶▶▶
Features	▶▶▶▶▶
OVERALL	▶▶▶▶▶

Frontech Gold JIL-7050 Smart Office keyboard

Keyway to the Web

Frontech Gold Smart Office keyboard is the next step in the natural evolution of a peripheral that is central to computing. It provides additional keys for Internet browsing and Microsoft Office applications. A user can perform standard browsing functions such as refreshing a page and navigating forward and backward between Web pages with the special keys provided on the keyboard. For the music maniacs, this keyboard provides buttons for complete volume controls as well as mute functions right above



the numeric keypad. It also has keys for the standard audio functions such as play, stop, next track and previous track and works well with Winamp. Installation of the keyboard is simple. Just attach the keyboard to your machine, put the installation

CD in your CD-ROM drive and load the drivers. Having done that, you have full control over the keyboard's various buttons.

A nifty joystick type of cursor controller is also offered, which substitutes the functions of arrow keys but takes some time getting used to. However, the keyboard poses a disadvantage for typ-

ists who are used to hitting the [Spacebar] right in the middle—the middle section of the [Spacebar] is thin (this is where the joystick is located), making it a little awkward. Other than these minor nags, this is a very utilitarian keyboard and is relatively well priced.

SPECIFICATIONS

PS/2 keyboard

Price: Rs 1,700
Contact: Jupiter Infosys Ltd
Phone: 022-2001211
Fax: 022-2001214
E-mail: frontech@bom2.vsnl.net.in
Web site: www.frontechgold.com

Frontech Gold JIL-7050

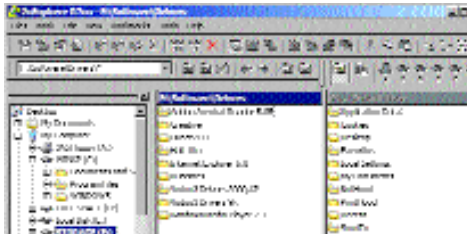
Performance	▶▶▶▶▶
Build quality	▶▶▶▶▶
Value for money	▶▶▶▶▶
Features	▶▶▶▶▶
OVERALL	▶▶▶▶▶

2xExplorer 1.3.1.12

Replacement file manager

2xExplorer is a file manager that combines the ease of the standard Windows explorer with the functionality and speed of an old school dual-pane file manager. 2xExplorer scores over Windows Explorer with its more sophisticated viewing filters and a beefed up file search tool. It has an in-built viewer that works with many popular graphics formats as well as HTML and Office documents and a file and folder shredder that ensures the complete destruction of any file you wish to delete. Another feature that we found very useful is its ability to print listings of folder contents.

However, getting the hang of all these features does take some time. Users will need to memorise the many shortcut combinations before they can really benefit from this package. Configuring the toolbars takes a while initially, but is definitely worth the time spent. What



really makes this software special is the fact that most tasks are just a shortcut away, boosting the speed at which the work is done. It provides support for bookmarks and Internet-style back/next folder navigation, as well as auto-completion for paths and other frequently typed information.

It is a good choice for power users and those who are just looking for simplicity. Plus it's completely free and takes up very little system resources, making it definitely worth the install.

SPECIFICATIONS

Windows 95/98/Me/2000/XP

Price: Freeware
Web site: www.netez.com

2xExplorer 1.3.1.12

Performance	▶▶▶▶▶
Ease of use	▶▶▶▶▶
Value for money	▶▶▶▶▶
Features	▶▶▶▶▶
OVERALL	▶▶▶▶▶